FORCIBLE ENTRY

Job Performance Requirements

NFPA 1010

6.3.4*

<u>Note:</u> All objectives in this section are testable.

Introduction

Subject: Forcible Entry

Note:

1. Forcible Entry refers to the techniques used to gain access into a compartment, structure, facility, or site when the normal means of entry is locked or blocked.
2. For consistency, the "Try before you Pry" method shall be performed prior to Forcible Entry. This refers to trying to open the access point by normal means.
3. There are multiple locking devices, which involve various tactics and tools, to force open.
4. The "Forcible Entry" procedures are NOT comprised of all the circumstances confronted in the ever-changing environments we experience. Nonetheless, the basic skills necessary to execute forcible entry are presented.
5. There are numerous categorized tools to achieve forcible entry, and some are specific to relevant applications.
    a. Cutting Tools
    b. Prying Tools
    c. Pushing/Pulling Tools
    d. Striking Tools
6. **Whenever possible, the "Through-the-Lock" method utilizing a K-Tool or A-Tool, should be attempted first. This technique is effective and does minimal damage to the door.**
7. There are two basic types of glass:
    a. **Plate glass: utilize blunt end of tool to break.**
    b. **Tempered glass: utilize pick end of tool to break.**
8. Hurricane windows are becoming more popular and are usually found in coastal states.
9. When breaking glass, **hands must be above the point of impact and outside the door or window frame.**
10. Full PPE shall be worn, including face mask and SCBA (IDLH) or face shield down (non-IDLH). Utilize a visual of the point of contact and loudly verbalize "BREAKING GLASS" to alert individuals of your actions. Be aware of the possibility of flying shards upon breaking glass.
11. Using a tool, **remove all remaining glass from the window frame in a safe manner.**
    a. Top
    b. Side nearest to you (Windward)
    c. Side away from you (Leeward)
    d. Bottom

Performance Objective

Subject: Forcible Entry

Task: Outward Swinging Doors (opens toward you)

Procedure:

1. Confirm order with command and select the appropriate tool(s).
2. If outside, approach from the windward side.
3. Check the conditions of the building (Example: Possible Backdraft).
4. Pull a glove down and use the back of your hand to feel the door for heat, starting at the bottom of the door and sliding your hand toward the top of the door.
5. Try before you Pry.
6. **Use through the lock method with K-Tool or A-Tool if possible.**
7. Position yourself with a shoulder or foot against the door.
8. Place the Adz or blade of the Halligan between the door and the jamb near the locking mechanism.
9. Another individual will strike and force the blade against the jamb.
10. Pry the tool away from the door, separating the door from the jamb. As you rotate your body, use the wall for protection.
11. Open the door when the lock has cleared the **Keeper/Receiver.**
12. Sweep and sound the floor before entering.

Performance Objective

Subject: Forcible Entry

Task: Inward Swinging Doors (opens away from you)

Procedure:

1. Confirm order with command and select the appropriate tool(s).
2. If outside, approach from the windward side.
3. Check the conditions of the building (Example: Possible Backdraft).
4. Pull a glove down and use the back of your hand to feel the door for heat, starting at the bottom of the door and sliding your hand toward the top of the door.
5. Try before you Pry.
6. **Use through the lock method with K-Tool or A-Tool if possible.**
7. **Secure the door by attaching a rope or webbing prior to forcing**.
8. Position yourself using the wall for protection.
9. Insert the Adz or blade of the Halligan between the door and jamb near the locking mechanism.
10. Make short pries to separate the door and jamb to create an access window.
11. To open the door, alternate the fork end to pry and push the door until the lock has cleared the **Keeper/Receiver.**
12. Sweep and sound the floor before entering.

Performance Objective

Subject: Forcible Entry

Task: Inward Swinging Doors (Wood Frame)

Procedure:

1. Confirm order with command and select the appropriate tool(s).
2. If outside, approach from the windward side.
3. Check the conditions of the building (Example: Possible Backdraft).
4. Pull a glove down and use the back of your hand to feel the door for heat, starting at the bottom of the door and sliding your hand toward the top of the door.
5. Try before you Pry.
6. **Use through the lock method with K-Tool or A-Tool if possible.**
7. **Secure the door by attaching a rope or webbing prior to forcing**.
8. Remove the **"Stop Jamb"** exposing the lock.
9. Position yourself using the wall for protection.
10. Insert the fork of the Halligan between the door and frame near the **Keeper/Receiver.**
11. Pry the tool away until the bolt has cleared the **Keeper/Receiver.**
12. Sweep and sound the floor before entering.

Performance Objective

Subject: Forcible Entry

Task: Double Swinging Doors

Procedure:

1. Confirm order with command and select the appropriate tool(s).
2. If outside, approach from the windward side.
3. Check the conditions of the building (Example: Possible Backdraft).
4. Pull a glove down and use the back of your hand to feel the door for heat, starting at the bottom of the door and sliding your hand toward the top of the door.
5. Try before you Pry.
6. **Use through the lock method with K-Tool or A-Tool if possible.**
7. Position yourself with a shoulder or foot against the door.
8. Place the Adz or blade of the Halligan between the doors near the locking mechanism.
9. Pry the tool away, separating the doors until the bolt has cleared the **Keeper/Receiver.**
10. Sweep and sound the floor before entering.

Performance Objective

Subject: Forcible Entry

Task: Tempered Glass Doors

Note: **Forcing these doors can cause the glass to break. It is preferred to break glass in a controlled, safe manner.**

Procedure:

1. Confirm order with command and select the appropriate tool(s).
2. Approach from the windward side.
3. Check the conditions of the building and look inside through the door (Example: Possible Backdraft).
4. **Try (do NOT Pry) before breaking glass.**
5. **Use through the lock method with K-Tool or A-Tool if possible.**
6. Using a pointed striking tool, strike the bottom corner of the glass panel.
7. Clear remaining glass from the door edge.
8. Remove any obstructions from the opening.
9. Sweep and sound the floor before entering.

Performance Objective

Subject: Forcible Entry

Task: Sliding Doors

Procedure:

1. Confirm order with command and select the appropriate tool(s).
2. Approach from the windward side.
3. Check the conditions of the building and look inside through the door (Example: Possible Backdraft).
4. If the door is barred or blocked, the glass must be broken, or another point of entry must be found.
5. Try before you Pry.
6. Doors that slide into an adjacent wall, should be pried in a manner similar to a swinging door. Although, it must be pried straight back from the frame.
7. Patio Sliding Doors, a panel should be pried up or lifted out of its track and removed in one piece.
8. If unable to pry and remove panel, then breaking the glass must be accomplished to gain entry.

   Note: Industry sliding doors could possibly be either Tempered or Plate glass.

9. Remove any obstructions from the opening.
10. Sweep and sound the floor before entering.

Performance Objective

Subject: Forcible Entry

Task: Overhead Sectional Doors

Procedures:

1. Confirm order with command and select the appropriate tool(s).
2. Approach from the windward side.
3. Check the conditions of the building (Example: Possible Backdraft).
4. Try before you Pry.
5. Confirm if the door has a separate motor drive or remote control.
6. Pry upward at the bottom of the door.
7. If unsuccessful, break and remove a panel out of the door. Reach in and use the internal mechanism to open.
8. If unsuccessful, use a rotary saw to make a triangular shaped cut of sufficient size to gain entry.
9. After entering, unlock and open the door.
10. Use a wedge, vice grips or any device, to effectively block and keep the door open so it will not close.
11. Sweep and sound the floor before entering.

Performance Objective

Subject: Forcible Entry

Task: Overhead Rolling Steel Doors

Procedures:

1. Confirm order with command and select the appropriate tool(s).
2. Approach from the windward side.
3. Check the conditions of the building (Example: Possible Backdraft).
4. Try before you Pry.

   Note: "Rolling Steel Doors" are among the toughest forcible entry challenges faced by firefighters.

5. Use a rotary saw to make a triangular shaped cut of sufficient size to gain entry.

   Note: A square or rectangular shaped cut can be made, however it is more labor intensive and time consuming.

6. If possible, unlock and open the door.
7. Use a wedge, vice grips or any device, to effectively block and keep the door open so it will not close.
8. Sweep and sound the floor before entering.

Performance Objective

Subject: Forcible Entry

Task: Through the Lock Method; K-Tool

Note: Training Centers are NOT required to purchase a K-Tool**. However, ALL students must have knowledge of this tool and its use.**

Procedures:

1. Confirm order with command and select the appropriate tool(s).
2. Approach from the windward side.
3. Check the conditions of the building (Example: Possible Backdraft).
4. Pull a glove down and use the back of your hand to feel the door for heat, starting at the bottom of the door and sliding your hand toward the top of the door.
5. Try before you Pry.
6. Slide K-Tool over the lock cylinder on the door.
7. Tap the K-Tool down with the Halligan or flat head axe.
8. Insert the Adz of the Halligan into the stirrup of the K-Tool.
9. Pry upward causing the cylinder to pull out of the door.
10. Confirm the type of locking mechanism.
11. Use a key tool to manipulate the lock device.
13. When latch is released or the bolt has cleared the **Keeper/Receiver,** open the door.
14. Sweep and sound the floor before entering.

Performance Objective

Subject: Forcible Entry

Task: Through the Lock Method; A-Tool

Note: Training Centers are NOT required to purchase an A-Tool. **However, ALL students must have knowledge of this tool and its use.**

Procedures:

1. Confirm order with command and select the appropriate tool(s).
2. Approach from the windward side.
3. Check the conditions of the building (Example: Possible Backdraft).
4. Pull a glove down and use the back of your hand to feel the door for heat, starting at the bottom of the door and sliding your hand toward the top of the door.
5. Try before you Pry.
6. Slide V notch of the A-Tool over the lock cylinder on the door.
7. Tap the A-Tool, with a flat head axe, firmly behind the lock cylinder.
8. If necessary, insert the blade of the axe behind the head of the A-Tool to prevent damaging the door while prying.
9. Pry upward causing the cylinder to pull out of the door.
10. Confirm the type of locking mechanism.
11. Use a key tool to manipulate the lock device.
12. When latch is released or the bolt has cleared the **Keeper/Receiver,** open the door.
13. Sweep and sound the floor before entering.

Performance Objective

Subject: Forcible Entry

Task: Fixed Glass Panel; Plate glass

Notes: For consistency, try before you pry.

Procedures:

1. Confirm order with command and select the appropriate tool(s).
2. Approach from the windward side.
3. Check the conditions of the building and look inside the window.
4. Standing on the windward side of the window, **hands must be above the point of impact and outside the window frame,** use the blunt end of a tool and strike the top corner of the pane.
5. Using a tool, remove all remaining glass from the window frame.
6. Remove any obstructions around the window.
7. Sweep and Sound the floor for structural integrity before entering structure.

Performance Objective

Subject: Forcible Entry

Task: Fixed Glass Panel; Tempered glass

Notes: For consistency, try before you pry.

Procedures:

1. Confirm order with command and select the appropriate tool(s).
2. Approach from the windward side.
3. Check the conditions of the building and look inside the window.
4. Standing on the windward side of the window, **hands must be above the point of impact and outside the window frame,** use the pick or point end of a tool and strike the bottom corner of the pane.
5. Using a tool, remove all remaining glass from the window frame.
6. Remove any obstructions around the window.
7. Sweep and Sound the floor for structural integrity before entering structure.

Performance Objective

Subject: Forcible Entry

Task: Checkrail Windows/Single or Double Hung; Wood Frame

Procedures:

1. Confirm order with command and select the appropriate tool(s).
2. Approach from the windward side.
3. Check the conditions of the building.
4. Remove the window screen and look inside the window.
5. Try before you Pry.
6. Pry upward in the center of the bottom sash. This should dislodge the locking device from the wood sash allowing the window to open.
7. If unsuccessful, stand on the windward side of the window and break the glass of the lower pane:
    a. Plate glass, in the top corner with the blunt end of tool.
    b. Tempered glass, in the bottom corner with the pick end of tool.
8. Using a tool, remove all remaining glass from the window sash.
9. Unlock the window and slide the lower sash upward.
10. If necessary, use a wedge to effectively block and keep the window sash open so it will not close.
11. Remove any obstructions around the window.
12. Sweep and Sound the floor for structural integrity before entering structure.

Performance Objectives

Subject: Forcible Entry

Task: Checkrail Windows/ Single or Double Hung; Metal Frame

Procedures:

1. Confirm order with command and select the appropriate tool(s).
2. Approach from the windward side.
3. Check the conditions of the building.
4. Remove the window screen and look inside the window.
5. Try before you Pry.
6. Attempt to gently pry upward in the center of the bottom sash, in case window is not properly secured.

   Note: Applying too much force when prying metal frame windows usually will prematurely break the glass.

7. If unsuccessful, stand on the windward side of the window and break the glass of the lower pane:
   a. Plate glass, in the top corner with the blunt end of tool.
   b. Tempered glass, in the bottom corner with the pick end of tool.
8. Using a tool, remove all remaining glass from the window sash.
9. Unlock the window and slide the lower sash upward.
10. If necessary, use a wedge to effectively block and keep the window sash open so it will not close.
11. Remove any obstructions around the window.
12. Sweep and Sound the floor for structural integrity before entering structure.

Performance Objective

Subject: Forcible Entry

Task: Casement Windows

Procedures:

1. Confirm order with command and select the appropriate tool(s).
2. Approach from the windward side.
3. Check the conditions of the building and look inside the window.
4. Try before you Pry.
5. Attempt to pry outward in the center of the sash.
6. If unsuccessful, stand on the windward side of the window and break the glass of the lowest pane:
    a. Plate glass, in the top corner with the blunt end of tool.
    b. Tempered glass, in the bottom corner with the pick end of tool.

    Note: If a crank is not present, break the pane closest to the lock.

7. Using a tool, remove all remaining glass from the window sash.
8. Remove the screen and unlock the window.
9. Operate the crank to open the window.
10. Remove any obstructions around the window.
11. Sweep and Sound the floor for structural integrity before entering structure.

Performance Objectives

Subject: Forcible Entry

Task: Awning Windows

Procedures:

1. Confirm order with command and select the appropriate tool(s).
2. Approach from the windward side.
3. Check the conditions of the building and look inside the window.
4. Try before you Pry.
5. Attempt to pry outward in the bottom center of the sash.
6. If unsuccessful, stand on the windward side of the window and break the glass of the lowest awning:
    a. Plate glass, in the top corner with the blunt end of tool.
    b. Tempered glass, in the bottom corner with the pick end of tool.
7. Using a tool, remove all remaining glass from the window sash.
8. Remove the screen and operate the crank to open the window.
9. Using the Halligan, **pry/pull and remove the sash from the hinge**.
10. Remove any obstructions around the window.
11. Sweep and Sound the floor for structural integrity before entering structure.

Performance Objective

Subject: Forcible Entry

Task: Jalousie Windows

Note: These windows are commonly found on doors.

Procedures:

1. Confirm order with command and select the appropriate tool(s).
2. Approach from the windward side.
3. Check the conditions of the building and look inside the window.
4. Try before you Pry.
5. **Standing on the windward side of the window, remove all panes by breaking glass from top to bottom in one motion (Do NOT break each pane individually).**
6. Clear any remaining glass along the sides.
7. Remove the screen and any obstructions around the window.
8. Sweep and Sound the floor for structural integrity before entering structure.

Performance Objective

Subject: Forcible Entry

Task: Hurricane Windows (High-Security)

Note: These windows are commonly found in coastal states.

Procedures:

1. Confirm order with command and select the appropriate tool(s):
    a. Rotary Saw (Must be equipped with a carbide-tipped, medium-toothed blade); or
    b. Chainsaw (Must be equipped with a carbide chain).
    c. Axe or adz end of Halligan (This approach is similar to breaking laminated glass in a vehicle windshield; however, it is labor intensive and time consuming).
2. Approach from the windward side.
3. Check the conditions of the building and look inside the window.
4. Standing on the windward side of the window, **start all cuts at full RPM to avoid bouncing, binding, and vibration of the saw.**
5. For **Checkrail/Opening** (Single or Double Hung) type windows, use the following method:
    a. Cut a triangular shaped hole near the locking device. **Make the 1st cut along the sash, then the side cuts creating the point of the triangle away from the sash/lock.**
    b. Ensure the opening is large enough for your gloved hand to reach through **OR** may choose to cut out the whole window.
    c. Unlock and raise the sash.
    d. If necessary, use a wedge to effectively block and keep the window open so it will not close.
6. For **Fixed/Non-opening** type windows, make cuts in the following order:
    a. The 1st cut, horizontally at the highest point of the window. Start at the leeward side and cut toward the windward side along the frame.
    b. The 2nd cut, horizontally at the lowest point of the window. Start at the leeward side and cut toward the windward side along the frame.
    c. The 3rd cut, vertically on the leeward side of the window. Start at the top and cut downward along the frame.
    d. The 4th and final cut, vertically on the windward side of the window. Start at the top and cut downward along the frame.
7. Remove any obstructions around the window.
8. Sweep and Sound the floor for structural integrity before entering structure.